

WATER & SPRINGS · RANGERS

Bringing a spring back.

A thousand litres, twice a day, for eight days. Then a koala came to drink.

This is a super spring area — water welling up from an underground system so wide it drains through multiple artesian basins, some sitting on top of ancient riverbeds, each one chemically different from the next. QUT is out here now, testing what makes each spring behave the way it does.

One of them had gone dry.

We cleaned the water hole out. And when we cleaned it out, we went down and planted grasses, and we went down twice a day and watered it — a thousand litres of water, twice a day, because we're in drought. Because we rainmake.

Eight days of carting water to a hole that wasn't holding any of it.

And then after the eight days in, it held a puddle of water.

We came the next morning, and there was a koala.

In her own colour-coded system for reading Country — the same one that gives cultural burning its place on the spectrum — spring restoration gets its own colour too.

Turquoise.

It isn't an isolated fix. Across the property, new springs have started appearing after heavy rain — the water table resetting itself, decades of pressure finding new places to surface. What happened at this one hole is small only if you don't know what it's connected to.

Underground, it's all one system. It just needed someone to notice which part was thirsty.

Suzanne Thompson, recorded on Country, 2026. Spring hydrology detail from on-Country accounts and ongoing research with Queensland University of Technology.